

Absolutely — **viral** is an excellent Tier 1 polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “many young people dream of going **viral**.”

Here **viral** means **spreading extremely quickly online from person to person through sharing, reposting, recommendation algorithms, and attention**. But the word also has a major medical meaning involving **viruses**, and several common modern extensions.

Word family: **virus / viral / virally**

Base noun: virus

Adjective: viral

Adverb: virally

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞)

Meaning in your passage: **viral = spreading rapidly online — 在網上爆紅的；迅速瘋傳的**

Your sentence:

> “many young people dream of going **viral**.”

Here **viral** means:

> **becoming extremely popular online within a short time because many people rapidly share, watch, comment on, or recommend the content.**

繁體中文：

內容在網絡上短時間內被大量觀看、分享、轉發或討論，因而迅速爆紅

Natural translation:

> “dream of going viral”

「夢想自己的內容能夠**在網上爆紅 / 瘋傳**」

So here:

> **viral = 在網絡上迅速大量傳播並獲得高度關注的**

1. **viral = spreading rapidly online — 爆紅的；瘋傳的**

This is the exact source sense.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Many young people dream of going ****viral****.”

「很多年輕人都夢想自己能在網上****爆紅****。」

Practice 2

> “The video went viral overnight.”

「那段影片一夜之間****爆紅 / 瘋傳****。」

Practice 3

> “Her post became viral within a few hours.”

「她的貼文幾小時內就****迅速爆紅****。」

****viral — internet = 網上內容在短時間內被大量傳播並吸引巨大注意****

2. ****go viral = 在網上爆紅 ; 迅速瘋傳****

A very important fixed expression.

Practice 4

> “The clip ****went viral**** after a celebrity shared it.”

「一位名人分享那段短片後，它就****爆紅了****。」

Practice 5

> “No one expected the joke to go viral.”

「沒有人料到這個笑話會****在網上瘋傳****。」

****go viral = 原本普通的網上內容突然被大量傳播並獲得廣泛關注****

This is one of the highest-value expressions in your passage.

3. ****viral = caused by a virus — 病毒引起的 ; 病毒性的****

A major medical meaning.

Practice 6

> “The doctor said it was a **viral infection**.”

「醫生說那是**病毒感染**。」

Practice 7

> “Some viral illnesses clear up without antibiotics.”

「有些**病毒性疾病**不用抗生素也會自行好轉。」

viral — medical = 由病毒引起或與病毒感染有關的

This is a completely different domain from social media.

4. **viral = relating to viruses — 與病毒有關的**

A broader scientific sense.

Practice 8

> “Scientists are studying **viral transmission**.”

「科學家正在研究**病毒傳播**。」

Practice 9

> “The lab focuses on viral genetics.”

「這間實驗室專門研究**病毒遺傳學**。」

viral = 與病毒本身、其結構、傳播、基因或作用有關的

5. **viral load = 病毒量**

A common medical compound.

Practice 10

> “The treatment reduced the patient’s ****viral load****.”

「治療降低了病人的****病毒量****。」

Practice 11

> “Doctors monitored changes in viral load.”

「醫生監察****病毒量****的變化。」

****viral load** = 體內某種病毒的數量 / 濃度******

6. ****viral infection** = 病毒感染******

Practice 12

> “Most colds are caused by ****viral infections****.”

「大多數感冒都是由****病毒感染****引起的。」

Practice 13

> “The symptoms suggested a viral infection rather than a bacterial one.”

「症狀顯示這比較像是****病毒感染****，而不是細菌感染。」

7. ****viral transmission** = 病毒傳播******

Practice 14

> “Masks can reduce some forms of ****viral transmission****.”

「口罩可以減少某些形式的****病毒傳播****。」

Practice 15

> “Researchers examined how viral transmission occurred.”

「研究人員分析了****病毒如何傳播****。」

****viral transmission** = 病毒由一個宿主 / 個體傳到另一個宿主 / 個體的過程******

8. **viral vector = 病毒載體**

A technical scientific/medical sense.

Practice 16

> “The treatment uses a **viral vector** to deliver genetic material.”

「這項治療使用**病毒載體**來傳送遺傳物質。」

Practice 17

> “Scientists modified the viral vector to make it safer.”

「科學家改造了**病毒載體**，使其更安全。」

viral vector = 經處理後用來把遺傳物質送入細胞的病毒載體系統

Register:

* technical

* biomedical

9. **viral marketing = 病毒式行銷；病毒行銷**

A major business/media extension.

Practice 18

> “The company used **viral marketing** to promote the product.”

「公司使用**病毒式行銷**來推廣產品。」

Practice 19

> “The campaign relied on viral marketing rather than traditional advertising.”

「這個宣傳活動主要依靠**病毒式行銷**，而不是傳統廣告。」

viral marketing = 利用人與人之間快速分享資訊，使宣傳像病毒一樣擴散的行銷方式

10. **viral content = 病毒式傳播內容；爆紅內容**

Practice 20

> “Brands often try to create **viral content**.”

「品牌經常嘗試製作**爆紅內容**。」

Practice 21

> “There is no guaranteed formula for viral content.”

「要製作**病毒式傳播內容**，沒有保證成功的公式。」

viral content = 特別容易被大量分享、轉發和討論的網上內容

11. **viral trend = 爆紅趨勢；網絡熱潮**

Practice 22

> “The dance became a **viral trend**.”

「這個舞蹈變成了**網絡爆紅熱潮**。」

Practice 23

> “Viral trends can disappear very quickly.”

「**網絡熱潮**可能很快消失。」

viral trend = 在網絡平台上迅速擴散並被大量模仿 / 參與的潮流

12. **viral moment = 爆紅時刻；網絡瘋傳事件**

Practice 24

> “The interview created a **viral moment**.”

「那次訪問創造了一個**爆紅時刻**。」

Practice 25

> “One funny mistake turned into a viral moment.”

「一個有趣的小失誤變成了一次**網絡瘋傳事件**。」

viral moment = 某個瞬間 / 片段突然在網上被廣泛傳播和討論

13. **virus = disease-causing infectious agent — 病毒**

The core related noun.

Practice 26

> “The illness is caused by a **virus**.”

「這種疾病由**病毒**引起。」

Practice 27

> “Some viruses spread through the air.”

「有些**病毒**會透過空氣傳播。」

virus = 能感染生物細胞並利用宿主細胞複製的微小感染因子

14. **virus = malicious computer program — 電腦病毒**

A major technology extension.

Practice 28

> “The computer was infected with a **virus**.”

「這部電腦感染了**電腦病毒**。」

Practice 29

> “The software scans files for viruses.”

「這套軟件會掃描檔案是否含有**病毒程式**。」

****virus — computing = 能自行傳播、感染檔案或系統並造成破壞的惡意程式****

This extension is metaphorical from biological viruses.

15. ****virally = in a way that spreads rapidly online — 以病毒式方式；迅速瘋傳地****

Less common, but valid.

Practice 30

> “The clip spread ****virally**** across several platforms.”

「那段短片在多個平台上****迅速瘋傳****。」

Practice 31

> “The campaign was designed to spread virally.”

「這個活動的設計目的，是讓內容能****病毒式擴散****。」

****virally = 以快速、人傳人的方式大量擴散****

Register:

* less common than “go viral”

* more formal/technical in marketing discussions

Important distinction: ****viral vs popular****

****popular****

= liked or enjoyed by many people.

****viral****

= spreading extremely quickly through online sharing/attention.

Something can be:

> popular but not viral

= 很受歡迎，但沒有突然瘋傳。

And something can go viral briefly without remaining popular for long.

Important distinction: **viral vs famous**

famous

= widely known.

viral

= spreading rapidly.

A person or video may go viral and then become famous, but the two are not identical.

> viral = 傳播速度

> famous = 知名程度

Important distinction: **viral vs trending**

trending

= currently receiving increased attention/discussion on a platform.

viral

= spreading extremely quickly and widely.

A topic can trend without becoming truly viral.

And viral content often becomes trending, but not always.

Important distinction: **viral vs contagious**

You already have **contagious** mapped.

viral

medical:

= caused by/related to a virus.

contagious

= capable of spreading from one person to another.

A viral illness is not automatically highly contagious, and a contagious disease need not necessarily be viral.

Important distinction: **viral vs infectious**

viral

= specifically related to viruses.

infectious

= caused by infectious agents more broadly:

- * viruses
- * bacteria
- * fungi
- * parasites, etc.

So:

- > viral infection
- > is one type of
- > infectious disease

Important distinction: **viral vs bacterial**

viral infection

= 病毒感染

bacterial infection

= 細菌感染

This matters medically because treatment differs.

Important distinction: **viral — internet vs medical**

This is the strongest contrast.

Internet:

> “The video went viral.”

= 影片爆紅了。

Medical:

> “It is a viral infection.”

= 這是病毒感染。

Same adjective, completely different domain.

Excellent MCQ material.

Important distinction: **viral — literal vs metaphorical**

The online meaning is metaphorical.

A biological virus:

> spreads rapidly between hosts.

Online content:

> spreads rapidly between users.

That metaphor is the semantic bridge.

Important distinction: **go viral vs become popular**

become popular

= gradually or generally become well liked.

go viral

= usually suggests sudden, rapid, high-volume online spread.

Your passage strongly emphasizes this:

> one night → over 100,000 likes

So **go viral** is more precise.

Important distinction: **viral content vs viral marketing**

viral content

= the item that spreads rapidly.

viral marketing

= the strategy designed to encourage such rapid sharing.

> viral video

> = 爆紅影片

> viral marketing campaign

> = 病毒式行銷活動

Important distinction: **virus — biology vs computing**

Biology:

> virus

> = 病毒

Computing:

> computer virus

> = 電腦病毒

The computing sense copies the idea of:

* infection

* replication

* spreading

* damage

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

* **viral — internet** = 爆紅 / 瘋傳的
* **go viral** = 在網上爆紅
* **viral — medical** = 病毒引起的 / 病毒性的
* **viral — scientific** = 與病毒有關的
* **viral infection** = 病毒感染
* **viral load** = 病毒量
* **viral transmission** = 病毒傳播
* **viral vector** = 病毒載體
* **viral marketing** = 病毒式行銷
* **viral content** = 爆紅 / 病毒式傳播內容
* **viral trend** = 網絡爆紅熱潮
* **viral moment** = 爆紅時刻 / 瘋傳事件
* **virus — biological** = 病毒
* **virus — computing** = 電腦病毒
* **virally** = 以病毒式方式迅速擴散

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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viral — internet	網上內容在短時間內被大量觀看、分享、轉發或討論而迅速爆紅的
go viral	原本普通的網上內容突然被大量傳播並獲得廣泛關注
viral — medical	由病毒引起，或與病毒感染有關的
viral — scientific	與病毒的結構、基因、作用或傳播有關的
viral load	體內某種病毒的數量 / 濃度
viral transmission	病毒由一個宿主 / 個體傳到另一個的過程
viral vector	用來把遺傳物質送入細胞的病毒載體系統
viral marketing	利用人與人快速分享資訊來擴散宣傳的行銷方式
viral content	特別容易被大量分享、轉發和討論的網上內容
viral trend	在網絡平台迅速擴散並被大量參與 / 模仿的潮流
virus — biology	能感染生物細胞並利用宿主細胞複製的感染因子
virus — computing	能感染檔案 / 系統並自行傳播的惡意程式

For your original sentence

> “In an age when social media can turn an ordinary student into a minor celebrity overnight, many

young people dream of **going viral**."

The exact meaning is:

go viral = 一段貼文、影片或其他網上內容在極短時間內被大量觀看、分享、轉發和討論，令發布者突然獲得巨大關注。

Natural translation:

> **「在這個社交媒體可以一夜之間把普通學生變成小有名氣人物的年代，很多年輕人都夢想自己的內容能在網上爆紅。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **go viral** → 在網上爆紅
- > **viral video** → 爆紅影片
- > **viral trend** → 網絡熱潮
- > **viral marketing** → 病毒式行銷
- > **viral infection** → 病毒感染
- > **viral load** → 病毒量
- > **virus** → 病毒
- > **computer virus** → 電腦病毒
- > **viral vs popular** → 快速瘋傳 vs 廣受歡迎
- > **viral vs trending** → 大規模迅速擴散 vs 當下熱度上升